

**EXAM HINT****Computer-Based OET Exam****Highlighting vs Copy & Paste**

The OET Writing exam is **45 minutes total**, split into two phases. During the **first 5 minutes (reading time)**, candidates **cannot type and cannot highlight** — reading only. During the remaining **40 minutes (writing time)**, they can highlight the case notes AND type their letter — but they **cannot always copy and paste**.

This means:

- ✓ Once the 40-minute writing time begins, use highlighting to mark relevant data in the case notes before and while you write.
- ✓ Use the 5-minute reading time to read carefully and plan your letter. When writing time starts, highlight the patient's name, date, address, DOB, and key clinical details to guide your writing.
- ⚠ You will need to **type all content manually** — do not rely on copy-paste being available.
- ⚠ Practice typing the address, patient name, and DOB quickly and accurately from the case notes.

💬 **Dr. Ahmed's Tip:** Use the 5-minute reading time to read the case notes thoroughly and mentally plan your letter structure. The moment the 40-minute writing time starts, begin highlighting — then write. **This hint applies to all OET professions.**